



CHAPTER 1

Introduction



The only way to learn is by playing. The only way to win is by learning. And the only way to begin is by beginning.

— *Sam Reich* —





CHAPTER 2

Theoretical Background



There is a theory which states that if ever anyone discovers exactly what the Universe is for and why it is here, it will instantly disappear and be replaced by something even more bizarre and inexplicable.

There is another theory which states that this has already happened.

— *Douglas Adams* —





CHAPTER 3

Helium Rich Mass Transfer



All hands, this is the captain. Begin prepping all stations for first contact.

— *Captain Ed Mercer* —





CHAPTER 4

Post-Supernova Kinematics: The Natal Kick



And the memories were lost long ago

But at least you have beautiful ghosts.

— *Taylor Swift* —





CHAPTER 5

Detailed Models of Overcontact Binary Stars



I can remember... sitting on a rooftop. Looking up and wondering what the stars were. I assumed I'd never know.

— *Hoid* —





CHAPTER 6

Conclusion



The glow of summer has faded, now... and the moonlight jellies carry on towards
the great unknown.

— *Stardew Valley* —





APPENDIX A

Additional Derivations



Algebra's like sheet music. The important thing isn't can you read music, it's can you *hear* it. Can you hear the music, Robert?

— *Niels Bohr, in Oppenheimer* —





APPENDIX B

Code Metadata



First learn computer science and all the theory. Next develop a programming style.

Then forget all that and just hack.

— *George Carrette* —





APPENDIX C

Period-Eccentricity distributions along the LVK Collaboration O3 contour



Statistics is the grammar of science.

— *Karl Pearson* —





APPENDIX D

Bespoke Overcontact Binary Models



All models are wrong, but some are useful.

— *George E. P. Box* —





APPENDIX E

Overcontact Binary Remnants



I only tell stories, Your Grace. They may be truths, they may be fictions. All I know
is that the stories themselves exist and that I must tell them.

— *Hoid* —





APPENDIX F

Code Samples



Any fool can write code that a computer can understand. Good programmers write code that humans can understand.

— *Martin Fowler* —

